MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SPONGE, SURGICAL, GAUZE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a non-sterile, pre-washed absorbent gauze sponge, suitable for use as a surgical preparation, for cleansing wounds or as a post-surgical dressing.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

PPP-B-585	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood
PPP-B-621	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner
PPP-B-636	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Military

MIL-L-10547	Liners, Case and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible

FSC 6510

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other Publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

UNITED STATES PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

Pharmacopeia of the United States

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Gauze shall be Type A or Type B as indicated herein.

3.1.1 Type A. Cotton threads shall be woven into an open fabric with selvaged edges. The fabric shall be bleached white. The gauze shall be treated with caustic, bleached, and then slack laundered so that it has excess crimp in both the warp and filling direction, resulting in a finished structure so that one layer will cling to an under layer. Material shall have a nominal unstretched width of 27 inches. The finished material shall meet the requirements of the Pharmacopeia of the United States (U.S.P.), except that the thread count shall be minimum of 8 in the filling and minimum of 12 in the warp.

3.1.2 Type B. Gauze used shall be Type VII gauze, in accordance with the U.S.P.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 Construction with Type A gauze. The gauze material shall be cut into 16 inch lengths. Cuts shall be at right angles to the selvage edges. The gauze shall be "Z" folded evenly to 3-ply, forming a pad 9 inches wide by 16 inches long. The cut edges shall be folded toward the center, forming a pad 9 inches wide by 8 inches long. Corners of the pad shall then be folded inward, forming a diamond shaped pad with nominal overall dimensions of 6-1/4 by 7 inches (point to point). Folding shall be as specified in Figure 1.

3.2.2 Construction with Type B gauze. An 18 inch by 16 inch (nominal) rectangle of gauze (288 square inches minimum) shall have the four corners folded inward to slightly overlap. The four folded corners shall be again folded inward to slightly overlap. If necessary, to obtain dimensions of 4 inches minimum by 8 inches maximum, this folding shall be repeated a third time. The finished sponge shall have one side as a continuous gauze surface, the other side shall have folded inward sections.

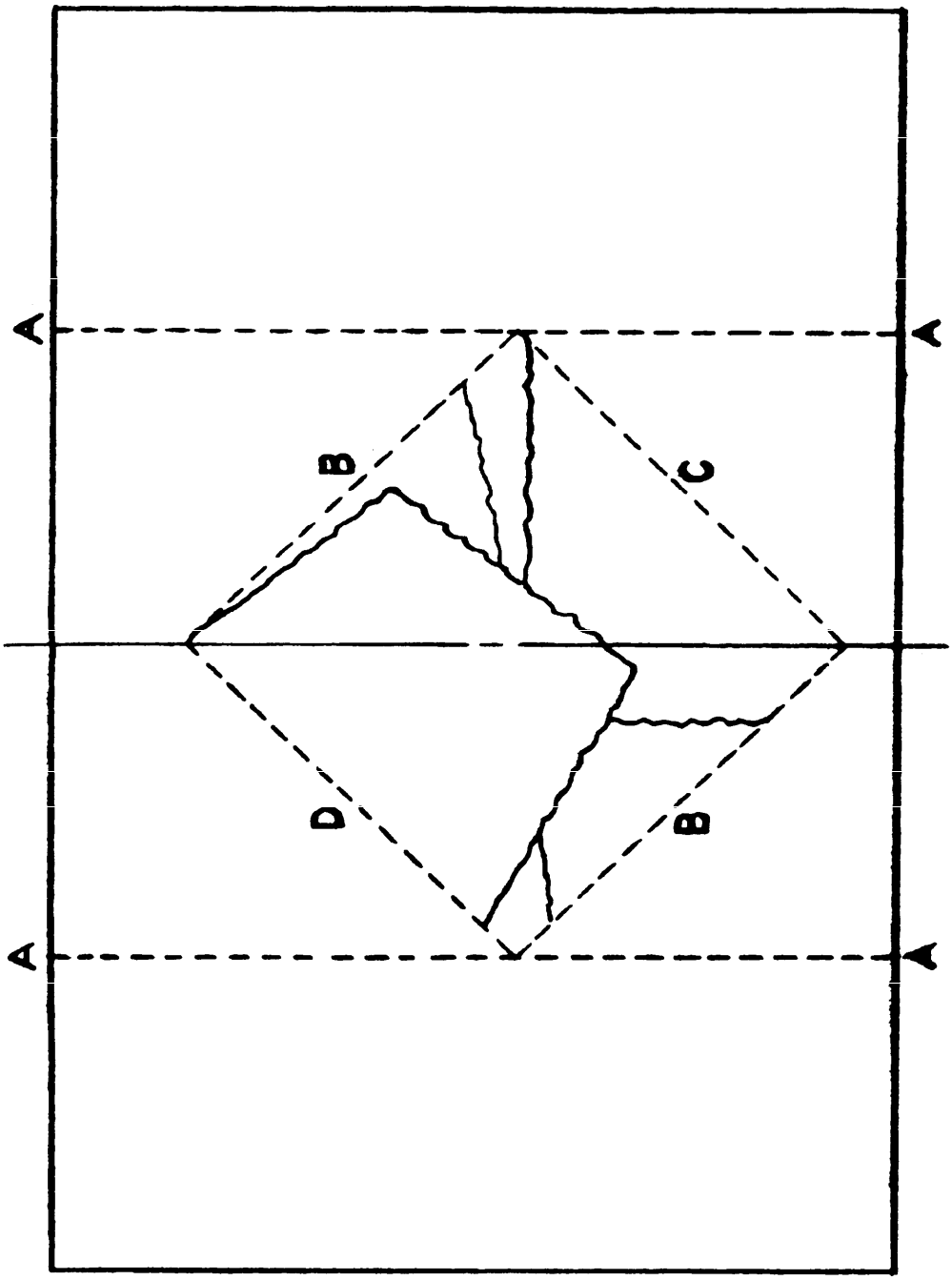
3.3 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Completed sponges shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



NOTES:
1. DASH LINES SHOW POSITION OF FOLDS, AND LETTERS REPRESENT ORDER OF FOLDING FLUFFS.
2. LAST FOLD MUST OVERLAP PRECEDING FOLD.

Figure 1. Folding gauze to form sponge (Type A)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the gauze may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the item identification, the name of the material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels shall be as indicated in Table I. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one (1) sponge.

Table I. Sampling for examination

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	S-4	1.0

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except that the acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes. At least one roll of treated gauze from each lot shall be tested.

4.3 Examinations. The sponges shall be examined for the defects listed in Table II. Examination shall not be restricted to those listed in Table II.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table II. Classification of defects

Classification	Defects
Major	
101	Sponge not clean, not free from dirt or other foreign matter.
102	Sponge not one continuous piece.
103	Sponge not folded as specified.
104	Last fold does not overlap preceding fold.
105	Number of sponges not as specified.
106	Sponge not free of holes, tears, or cuts.
107	Color not as specified.
108	Sponge not free of loose threads, ravelings or lint.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Gauze. The gauze shall be tested for compliance with the U.S.P. The thread count shall be as specified in 3.1.1 or 3.1.2, as applicable.

4.5 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of Section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in Table III. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The Inspection Level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table III. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages and shipping containers not as specified.
Packaging and packing materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, tape improperly applied, or containers distorted.
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be Level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing five hundred (500) sponges as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1.1 Immediate container. Immediate container shall be a commercially immediate container. Container shall be acceptable to the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the product contained therein and shall be of such compatibility that neither the contents nor the container are altered in any way by each other. One or more sponges may be packaged in an immediate container.

5.1.1.1.2 Unit package. Each unit of issue (500 sponges) shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size and design constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, Type CF, Class domestic. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Two (2) units of issue shall be packed in a box designed for a Type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, Class 3, Style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, Class 2; or PPP-B-636, Type CF, Class weather resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each Level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Fiberboard boxes shall be waterproofed in accordance with PPP-B-636.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.2 Level B. Two (2) units of issue shall be packed in a box designed for a Type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, Class 1, Style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, Class 1; or PPP-B-636, Type CF, Class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Immediate container. Labeling shall be in accordance with the requirements of the Federal, Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, and shall include item name, manufacturer's name and address and Lot (control) number.

5.3.2 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Lot (control) number, contract or purchase order number, and name and address of manufacturer shall be shown. Date of manufacture shall be shown in lieu of date packed.

5.3.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Lot (control) number shall be shown. Date of manufacture shall be shown in lieu of date packed.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The gauze sponges covered by this specification are intended for use as a surgical preparation, for cleansing wounds and as a post-surgical dressing.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) National Stock Number (NSN)
(c) Packaging and packing levels (see 5.1 and 5.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.3 This specification is intended to cover the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6510-00-142-8728	SPONGE, SURGICAL, GAUZE

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6510-0605
cs

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Shock (specified pulse). Method 213, test condition I.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/ vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-S-37172 SPONGE, SURGICAL, GAUZE

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 72 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 JAN 68 WHICH MAY BE USED

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-21T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FOLD

DEFENSE PERSONNEL SUPPORT CENTER
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pa. 19101

POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
DEFENSE SUPPLY AGENCY
DoD - 304



OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

HEADQUARTERS, DEFENSE PERSONNEL SUPPORT CENTER
ATTN: DIRECTORATE OF MEDICAL MATERIEL, CODE ATT
2800 SOUTH 20TH STREET
PHILADELPHIA, PA. 19101

FOLD

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.